

# SOUL: IMMORTALITY, REBIRTH AND LIBERATION

SIX SURVIVAL TERMS → WESTERN IMMORTALITY ARGUMENTS → PERSONAL IDENTITY AFTER DEATH → KARMA, REBIRTH AND BUDDHIST → LIBERATION PARITY BENCH → VEDĀNTA AND JAIN ROUTES

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g12 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

## STAGE 00 SIX SURVIVAL TERMS

SIX SURVIVAL TERMS ALLEGED ENDURING SUBJECT PERSONAL IDENTITY WHAT MAKES LATER PERSON SAME SURVIVAL OF DEATH NEW EMBODIED EXISTENCE DIVINE RESTORATION OF EMBODIED PERSON RELEASE FROM BONDAGE

SOUL = alleged enduring subject

PERSONAL IDENTITY = what makes later person same

IMMORTALITY = survival of death

REBIRTH = new embodied existence

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SOUL = alleged enduring subject
- PERSONAL IDENTITY = what makes later person same
- IMMORTALITY = survival of death

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- REBIRTH = new embodied existence
- RESURRECTION = divine restoration of embodied person
- LIBERATION = release from bondage

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUESTIONS MUST BE KEPT DISTINCT what survives? → by what continuity criterion? → where/when? → through whose agency?
- is survival endless life, renewed embodiment, or freedom from rebirth?
- TERM CONTROL prevents treating Plato, Buddhism, Vedānta and Christianity as one doctrine.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Immortality, rebirth, reincarnation, resurrection and liberation make distinct claims about survival, embodiment and release.

01

## STAGE 01 WESTERN IMMORTALITY ARGUMENTS

WESTERN IMMORTALITY ARGUMENTS PLATO CYCLICAL ARGUMENT OPPOSITES ARISE FROM OPPOSITES RECOLLECTION A PRIORI KNOWLEDGE SUGGESTS PRENATAL EXISTENCE AFFINITY INVISIBLE RATIONAL SOUL RESEMBLES UNCHANGING FORMS PHAEDO FINAL ARGUMENT

SOUL ESSENTIALLY BEARS LIFE AND CANNOT ADMIT DEATH OBJECTIONS ENDLESS SURVIVAL; HARMONY ANALOGY; DEPENDENCE ON BRAIN

### DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- PLATO cyclical argument: opposites arise from opposites recollection: a priori knowledge suggests prenatal existence affinity: invisible rational soul
- resembles unchanging Forms
- Phaedo final argument: soul essentially bears life and cannot admit death objections: pre-existence != endless survival

### OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- harmony analogy
- dependence on brain
- DESIRE/JUSTICE ARGUMENTS: fulfilment or moral completion suggests afterlife limit: wish and moral need do not by themselves establish

### REPLY / RESIDUAL

- metaphysical survival.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Plato's arguments separately support pre-existence, affinity or simplicity and do not automatically establish personal immortality.

02

## STAGE 02 PERSONAL IDENTITY AFTER DEATH

PERSONAL IDENTITY AFTER DEATH IDENTITY CANDIDATES SAME IMMATERIAL SUBSTANCE BODILY CONTINUITY MEMORY AND PSYCHOLOGICAL CONTINUITY (LOCKE) CAUSAL NARRATIVE CONTINUITY BRAVE OFFICER EXPOSES MEMORY TRANSITIVITY PROBLEM DUPLICATION

ONE PSYCHOLOGY COPIED TWICE CANNOT YIELD TWO NUMERICALLY IDENTICAL

IDENTITY CANDIDATES

same immaterial substance

bodily continuity / resurrection

memory and psychological continuity (Locke)

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IDENTITY CANDIDATES
- same immaterial substance
- bodily continuity / resurrection

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- memory and psychological continuity (Locke)
- causal narrative continuity
- REID: brave officer exposes memory transitivity problem duplication: one psychology copied twice cannot yield two numerically identical persons

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- resurrection requires divine re-identification of this person, not mere replica production verdict depends on whether identity needs strict
- sameness or survival-grade continuity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — REID: brave officer exposes memory transitivity problem duplication: one psychology copied twice cannot yield two numerically identical persons resurrection requires divine re-identification of this person, not mere replica production verdict depends on whether identity needs strict sameness or survival-grade continuity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: brave officer exposes memory transitivity problem duplication: one psychology copied twice cannot yield two numerically identical persons resurrection requires divine re-identification of this person, not mere replica production verdict depends on whether identity needs strict sameness or survival-grade continuity.

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- IDENTITY CANDIDATES
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03

STAGE 03

KARMA, REBIRTH AND BUDDHIST CONTINUITY

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INDIAN REBIRTH

KARMA + SAṂSKĀRA/VĀSANĀ

RENEWED EMBODIMENT IN SAṂSĀRA

BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN FIVE SKANDHAS + DEPENDENT ORIGINATION

CAUSAL STREAM

REBIRTH WITHOUT TRANSMIGRANT FLAME-TO-FLAME

NEITHER NUMERICALLY IDENTICAL NOR WHOLLY UNRELATED INTENTION CONDITIONS LATER

INDIAN REBIRTH: karma + saṁskāra/vāsanā → renewed embodiment in saṁsāra

BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN five skandhas + dependent origination → causal stream → rebirth without transmigrant

memory is causally produced cognition objection: who receives karma?

reply: demand for substance mistakes continuity for identity nirvāṇa ends craving and the causal appropriation

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- INDIAN REBIRTH: karma + saṁskāra/vāsanā → renewed embodiment in saṁsāra
- BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN five skandhas + dependent origination → causal stream → rebirth without transmigrant flame-to-flame: neither numerically

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- memory is causally produced cognition objection: who receives karma?
- reply: demand for substance mistakes continuity for identity nirvāṇa ends craving and the causal appropriation that renews birth.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- INDIAN REBIRTH: karma + saṁskāra/vāsanā → renewed embodiment in saṁsāra
- BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN five skandhas + dependent origination → causal stream → rebirth without transmigrant flame-to-flame: neither numerically

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Buddhist rebirth preserves causal continuity without a permanent self, avoiding both numerical identity and total discontinuity.

04

STAGE 04

LIBERATION PARITY BENCH

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SCHOOL BONDAGE LIBERATION

ADVAITA AVIDYĀ, FALSE IDENTITY JÑĀNA

VÍŚIṢṬĀDVAITA KARMA, DEPENDENCE OBSCURED BHAKTI/PRAPATTI; COMMUNION

SĀṂKHYA-YOGA PURUṢA-PRAKṚTI CONFUSION KAIVALYA THROUGH VIVEKA

NYĀYA FALSE KNOWLEDGE, DOṢA, KARMA APAVARGA

CESSATION OF PAIN

JAINISM KARMIC PUḌGALA ON JĪVA KEVALA-JÑĀNA, SIDDHAHOOD

| SYSTEM / DOCTRINE                                                   | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                           | EVALUATION / TRAP                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SCHOOL BONDAGE LIBERATION                                           | Sāṁkhya-Yoga puruṣa-prakṛti confusion kaivalya through viveka  | Buddhism craving/ignorance nirvāṇa                                             |
| Advaita avidyā, false identity jñāna: ātman = Brahman               | Nyāya false knowledge, doṣa, karma apavarga: cessation of pain | Christianity sin/death resurrection and salvation                              |
| Vīśiṣṭādvaita karma, dependence obscured bhakti/prapatti; communion | Jainism karmic puḍgala on jīva kevala-jñāna, siddhahood        | SAME WORD “release” conceals different selves, causes, methods and end-states. |

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- SCHOOL BONDAGE LIBERATION
- Advaita avidyā, false identity jñāna: ātman = Brahman
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DECISIVE DISTINCTION

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EVALUATION / TRAP

- Buddhism craving/ignorance nirvāṇa
- Christianity sin/death resurrection and salvation
- SAME WORD “release” conceals different selves, causes, methods and end-states.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Liberation terms are not interchangeable, because each presupposes a different self, bondage, method and final state.

05

STAGE 05

VEDĀNTA AND JAIN ROUTES

VEDĀNTA AND JAIN ROUTES

SUBTLE BODY CARRIES KARMA UNTIL KNOWLEDGE; JĪVANMUKTI POSSIBLE

VIDEHAMUKTI ENDS EMBODIMENT, NOT THE ĀTMAN'S EXISTENCE

JĪVA REMAINS REAL AND DISTINCT; GRACE, BHAKTI AND PRAPATTI

JĪVA + PASSIONS/ACTIVITY

BANDHA SAṂVARA BLOCKS INFLUX

NIRJARĀ SHEDS KARMA

MOKṢĀ CONTRAST

| SYSTEM / DOCTRINE                                                       | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                                                                             | EVALUATION / TRAP                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ADVAITA: subtle body carries karma until knowledge; jīvanmukti possible | VÍŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: jīva remains real and distinct; grace, bhakti and prapatti lead to God                            | Rāmānuja perfects dependence                                     |
| videhamukti ends embodiment, not the ātman's existence                  | JAINISM: jīva + passions/activity → āsrava → bandha saṁvara blocks influx → nirjarā sheds karma → kevala-jñāna → | Jainism purges material karma from an eternally individual soul. |

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EVALUATION / TRAP

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EVALUATION / TRAP

- Rāmānuja perfects dependence
- Jainism purges material karma from an eternally individual soul.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Knowledge, action and devotion function as alternatives, preparations or integrated paths according to each school's theory of bondage.

06

STAGE 06

PATHS, OBJECTIONS AND ETHICAL MEANING

PATHS, OBJECTIONS AND ETHICAL MEANING

THREE BROAD MEANS

JÑĀNA (KNOWLEDGE)

BHAKTI (DEVOTION)

KARMA (DISCIPLINED ACTION)

YOGA ADDS MEDITATIVE DISCIPLINE; JAINISM ADDS VOWS/AUSTERITY; BUDDHISM EIGHTFOLD

DISEMBODIED SOUL LACKS INDIVIDUATION

REBIRTH LACKS MEMORY LIBERATION AS PAINLESSNESS SEEMS EMPTY

| DOCTRINE / CLAIM                                                                                                                                  | OBJECTION / PRESSURE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | REPLY / RESIDUAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>THREE BROAD MEANS: jñāna (knowledge)</li><li>bhakti (devotion)</li><li>karma (disciplined action)</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Yoga adds meditative discipline; Jainism adds vows/austerity; Buddhism eightfold path objections: disembodied soul lacks individuation</li><li>rebirth lacks memory liberation as painlessness seems empty</li><li>endless survival may be burden, not good replies: character/causal continuity can outlast episodic memory</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>liberation is evaluated by freedom from ignorance, craving or sin, not mere duration ethical test: doctrine should transform</li><li>present conduct, not postpone justice to another life.</li></ul> |

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Resurrection reconstitutes the person after one life, whereas rebirth repeats becoming and reincarnation specifically implies a transmigrating soul.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER RAIL

PYQ ANSWER RAIL

DEFINE EXACT SURVIVAL TERM

IDENTIFY BEARER AND CONTINUITY CRITERION

EXPLAIN CAUSAL MECHANISM

STATE SOTERIOLOGICAL END AND PATH

STRONGEST OBJECTION (IDENTITY, EVIDENCE, JUSTICE)

STRONGEST REPLY

COMPARE ONE UNLIKE DOCTRINE ON SAME AXES

DEFINE exact survival term → identify bearer and continuity criterion → explain causal mechanism → state soteriological end and path → strongest objection (identity, evidence, justice) → strongest reply → compare one unlike doctrine on same axes → qualified conclusion → ANSWER AXES: self/no-self

| DOCTRINE / CLAIM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | OBJECTION / PRESSURE                                                                                                                                                                                                   | REPLY / RESIDUAL                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>DEFINE exact survival term → identify bearer and continuity criterion</li><li>explain causal mechanism → state soteriological end and path</li><li>strongest objection (identity, evidence, justice) → strongest reply</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>compare one unlike doctrine on same axes → qualified conclusion</li><li>ANSWER AXES: self/no-self</li><li>continuity/identity endless existence/release from existence</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CLOSE: survival doctrines are credible only when their ontology of the person, continuity mechanism and ethical-liberative purpose support</li><li>one another.</li></ul> |

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CLOSE: survival doctrines are credible only when their ontology of the person, continuity mechanism and ethical-liberative purpose support one another.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A strong answer defines the survival criterion, compares unlike traditions on common axes and ends with a qualified identity verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

THESE REFINEMENTS STRENGTHEN A 15/20-MARKER BUT MUST REMAIN SUBORDINATE

TELEPORTATION, BRAIN-SPLIT CASES AND FRINGE REINCARNATION LITERATURE ARE DELIBERATELY

THE SIX SURVIVAL-TERMS AND THE NECESSITY QUESTION LAYER 3

IS IMMORTALITY OF A SUBSTANTIAL SOUL NECESSARY FOR REBIRTH?

IN THE SUBSTANTIALIST SYSTEMS (VEDANTA, NYAYA, JAINISM) AN ETERNAL

BUT BUDDHISM SECURES RE-BECOMING THROUGH A CAUSAL STREAM ALONE.

| OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED OBJECTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | COMPARATIVE NUANCE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]</li><li>These refinements strengthen a 15/20-marker but must remain subordinate to the owner doctrines.</li><li>Teleportation, brain-split cases and fringe reincarnation literature are deliberately excluded as low-return.</li><li>The Six Survival-Terms and the Necessity Question LAYER 3 - ADVANCED The necessity question is a modal question, so answer it with modal vocabulary.</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>ANALYSIS: Is immortality of a substantial soul NECESSARY for rebirth?</li><li>In the substantialist systems (Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism) an eternal atman or jīva is exactly what transmigrates, so there immortality is presupposed.</li><li>But Buddhism secures re-becoming through a causal stream alone.</li><li>So a persisting soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth, not NECESSARY -- Buddhism is the decisive counter-case.</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>ANALYSIS: Is rebirth necessary for liberation?</li><li>Liberation is defined as exit from the cycle, so it presupposes bondage-across-lives and something that is freed.</li><li>WRONG: Treating the one-screen map as one school's doctrine.</li><li>It is a comparative scaffold; each cell must be cashed out in that school's own terms.</li></ul> |

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.